

Repairs and Maintenance Policy

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Approved By:	Head of Property Services
Department:	Maintenance Operations

1. Purpose and Scope

DataCompany Housing Management is committed to maintaining all managed properties to a safe, habitable and fit-for-purpose standard throughout the duration of each tenancy. This policy defines the responsibilities of DataCompany and tenants, categorises repair types by urgency, outlines the process for reporting and resolving defects, and sets response time standards.

2. Responsibilities

2.1 DataCompany Responsibilities

- Maintain the structural integrity of all properties including roofs, walls, floors and foundations.
- Ensure all plumbing, electrical, heating and drainage systems are in safe and functional condition.
- Carry out all external decoration and upkeep of communal areas.
- Respond to repair requests within the timeframes defined in this policy.
- Engage qualified and vetted tradespeople for all maintenance work.
- Conduct regular planned maintenance inspections in accordance with DC-POL-006.

2.2 Tenant Responsibilities

- Report defects, damage or maintenance issues to DataCompany promptly via the tenant portal, telephone or email.
- Carry out minor household maintenance such as replacing light bulbs, smoke alarm batteries and keeping drains clear of blockages caused by tenant use.
- Avoid causing willful or negligent damage to the property or its fixtures and fittings.
- Allow authorised DataCompany contractors access to the property at reasonable times with prior notice.
- Not attempt structural, electrical or plumbing repairs without prior written consent from DataCompany.
- Ensure the property is adequately ventilated to prevent condensation and mould formation.

3. Repair Categories and Response Times

All repair requests are categorised upon receipt by DataCompany Maintenance Operations. The following priority framework governs response and resolution times:

Category	Priority Level	Description	Response Time	Resolution Target
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Category 1	Emergency	Immediate risk to life or property: gas leak, total electrical failure, severe structural damage, flooding	2 hours	24 hours
Category 2	Urgent	Significant impact on habitability: boiler failure, partial electrical outage, roof leak, blocked main drain	24 hours	5 working days
Category 3	Routine	Non-urgent but necessary: leaking tap, defective door lock, broken window (non-security risk), minor plaster damage	3 working days	21 working days
Category 4	Planned	Cyclical maintenance, decoration, external works scheduled in advance	Scheduled	As per maintenance plan

4. Reporting a Repair

Tenants may report repairs through any of the following channels. All reports are assigned a unique Job Reference Number that tenants should retain for follow-up enquiries.

Channel	Contact Details	Hours of Operation
Tenant Portal (preferred)	portal.datacompany.co.zw	24/7 online logging
Telephone	+263 4 700 100	Mon-Fri 08:00-17:00; Emergency 24/7
Email	repairs@datacompany.co.zw	Responded within 1 working day
In Person	DataCompany Offices, Harare	Mon-Fri 08:00-16:30

When reporting a repair, tenants should provide: full name, property address, nature and location of the defect, when the problem was first noticed, any immediate safety concerns, and preferred contact time for access arrangements.

5. Access for Repairs

DataCompany will provide a minimum of 24 hours written notice before attending a property for non-emergency repairs. For Category 1 emergencies, contractors may attend with minimal or no prior notice to protect life and property. Tenants are required to provide reasonable access; repeated failure to do so may result in the repair being suspended and the tenant being held liable for any consequential damage.

6. Tenant-Caused Damage

Where damage to a property or its fixtures is found to have been caused by the tenant, household members or their guests through negligence, misuse or deliberate action, the cost of repair will be recharged to the tenant. DataCompany will provide a written quote before commencing rechargeable works wherever possible. Recharge amounts will be deducted from the security deposit at the end of tenancy or invoiced separately where costs exceed the deposit balance.

7. Planned and Cyclical Maintenance

Maintenance Task	Frequency	Responsible Party
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Gas safety check and certificate	Annual	DataCompany (legal obligation)
Electrical installation condition report	Every 5 years	DataCompany
Smoke and CO detector testing	Annual (plus tenant monthly check)	DataCompany / Tenant
External painting and rendering	Every 7 years or as needed	DataCompany
Boiler service	Annual	DataCompany
Gutter clearing	Annual (pre-rainy season)	DataCompany
Pest control (communal areas)	Bi-annual	DataCompany
Internal decoration (communal)	Every 5 years	DataCompany

8. Complaints Regarding Repairs

If a tenant is dissatisfied with the response time, quality of work or conduct of a contractor, they should raise the matter under the Complaints and Dispute Resolution Policy (DC-POL-009). DataCompany takes repair quality seriously and all complaints are investigated within 10 working days.